

Visual Analysis: Airline Recovery Trajectory (2019-2025)

Introduction

This document presents a visual comparison of the recovery trajectories for major Indian and Gulf airlines following the COVID-19 pandemic. The analysis focuses on passenger traffic, revenue, load factors, and fleet evolution.

1 Passenger Traffic Recovery Index

The chart below illustrates the recovery of passenger volumes indexed to the 2019 baseline (100%).

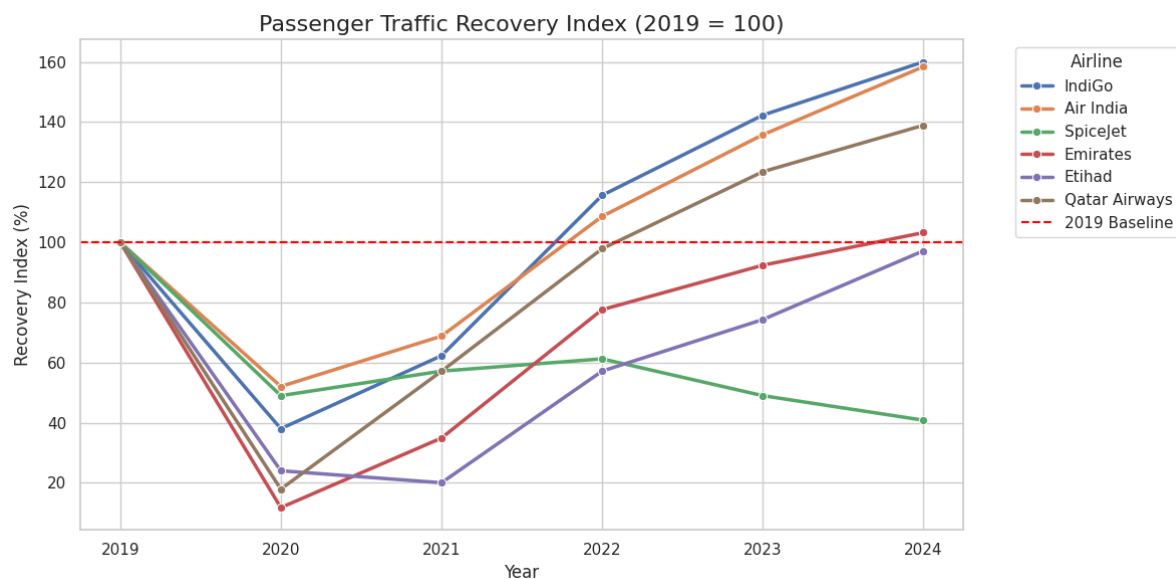


Figure 1: Passenger Traffic Recovery Index (2019 = 100)

Key Insights

- IndiGo and Air India have shown the most aggressive recovery, significantly exceeding their 2019 passenger levels by 2024.
- Gulf Airlines (Emirates, Qatar, Etihad) experienced a deeper dip in 2020 due to their reliance on international transit traffic but have steadily climbed back to pre-pandemic levels.
- SpiceJet is the outlier, with a declining trajectory post-2022, reflecting its ongoing operational and financial struggles.

2 Revenue Comparison: 2019 vs. 2024

This bar chart compares the total revenue (converted to INR Cr for parity) between the baseline year and the latest recovery year.

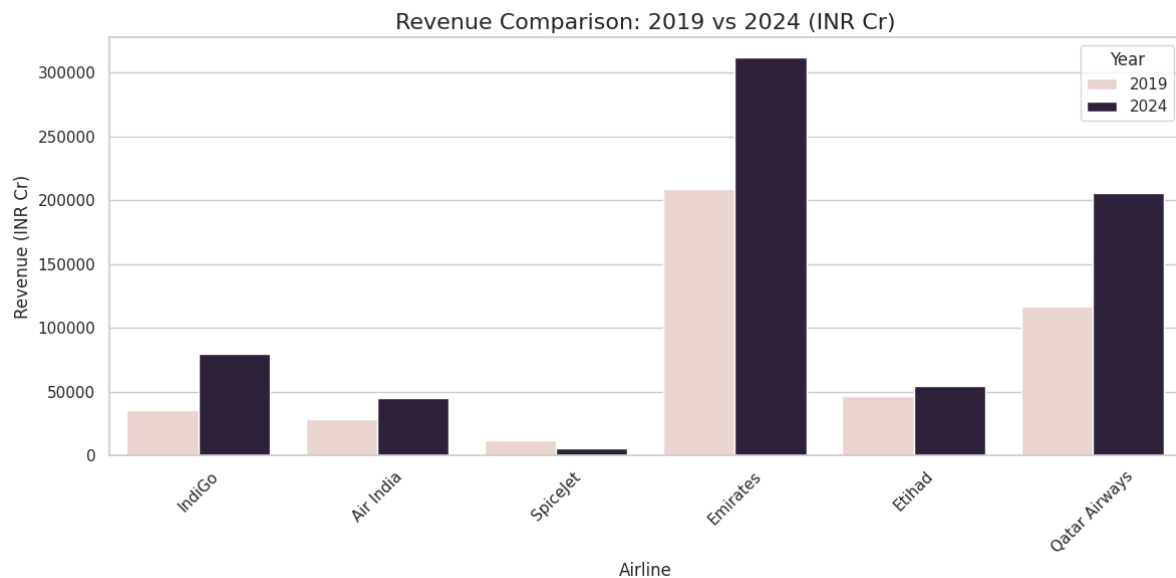


Figure 2: Revenue Comparison: 2019 vs. 2024 (INR Cr)

Key Insights

- Emirates remains the revenue giant in this group, with its 2024 revenue nearly doubling its 2019 levels in INR terms.
- IndiGo has more than doubled its revenue, showcasing the strength of the Indian domestic market.
- Qatar Airways has also seen substantial revenue growth, supported by its network resilience during the pandemic.

3 Average Load Factor: India vs. Gulf

Load factor measures how effectively airlines fill their available seats.

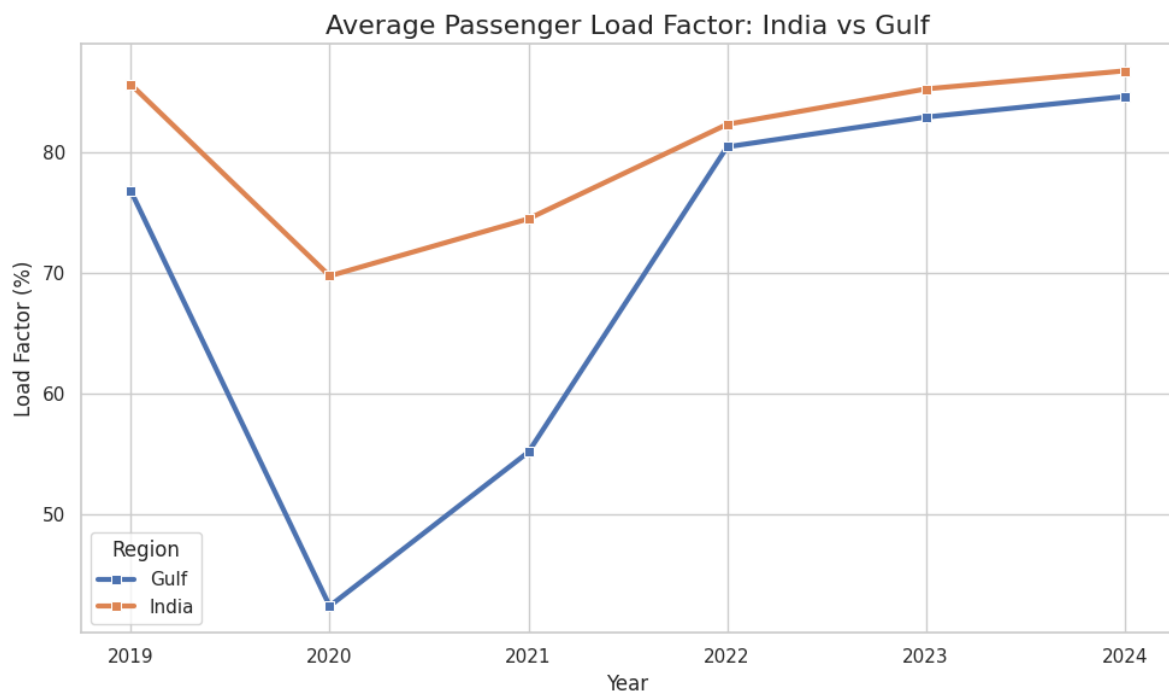


Figure 3: Average Passenger Load Factor: India vs. Gulf

Key Insights

- Indian Airlines generally maintained higher load factors throughout the recovery, driven by robust domestic demand.
- Gulf Airlines saw a dramatic drop in load factors in 2020-2021 but have since converged with Indian carriers as international travel restrictions eased.

4 Fleet Size Evolution

The evolution of fleet size indicates the long-term capacity strategy of each airline.

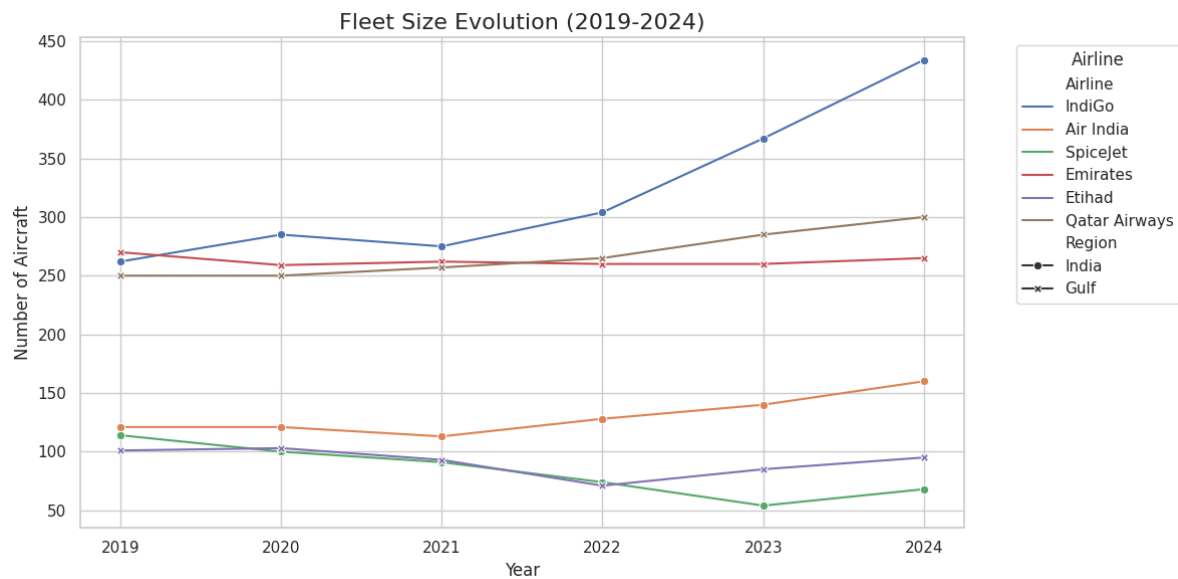


Figure 4: Fleet Size Evolution (2019-2024)

Key Insights

- IndiGo has consistently expanded its fleet, reaching over 400 aircraft by 2025.
- Air India is on a steep growth path following its privatization and massive aircraft orders.
- SpiceJet's fleet has contracted significantly, highlighting its capacity constraints.
- Gulf Carriers have maintained relatively stable fleet sizes while focusing on upgrading to more efficient, newer-generation aircraft.